UPFRONT

ECOWATCH: GUJARAT'S BIRDS CHIRP AWAY *PG 9*

VIEWPOINT: NEW COUNTER-TERROR POLICY *PG 10*

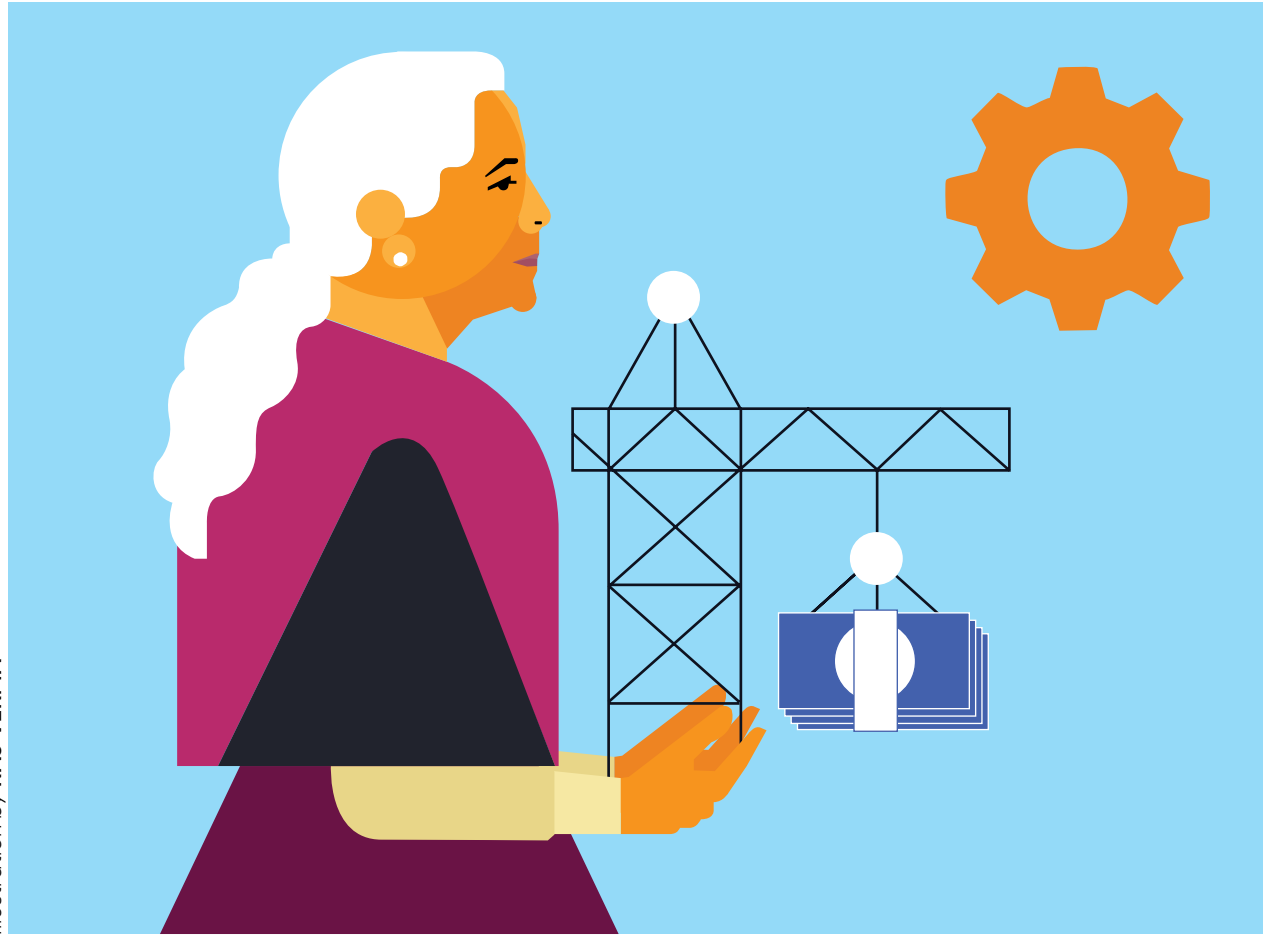


Illustration by RAJ VERMA

▶ DIVESTMENT PLAN

BRING HOME THE MONEY

The second phase of the Centre's asset monetisation plan, NMP 2.0, more than doubles the target to Rs 16.72 lakh crore, much of it to be mopped up by 2030

By M.G. ARUN

AFTER A 'SUCCESSFUL' OUTING FIRST TIME AROUND, Union finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman launched the second phase of the Centre's ambitious asset monetisation programme on February 23. The target: Rs 16.72 lakh crore, some 2.6 times of what it was for National Monetisation Pipeline (NMP) 1.0. This includes private sector investment of Rs 5.8 lakh crore in the assets of central ministries and public sector entities. NMP 2.0 will be spread over a five-year period till FY30, with asset monetisation involving handing over holdings like highways, airports and mines to the private sector for a defined period for redevelopment, or divestment of a portion of the government's stake in listed firms. The move could boost India's GDP by Rs 40 lakh crore over the next 5-10 years, says government think-tank NITI Aayog.

NMP 2.0 will play a key role in unlocking value from